

Flashlights in the Dark

Set in 2076

Commissioned by the Philharmonic Chorus of Madison

Jon D. Nelson

Moderato (♩ = c. 102)

Begin in darkness

Sounds of
flowing water

nighttime sounds mixed with
cacophony plus shimmery jingling

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Shadow Chorus

Soprano S

Alto S

Baritone S

Light Chorus

Soprano L1/L2

Alto L1/L2

Tenor/Bass L

Shadow Chorus

Sop. S

Alto S

Bar. S

Light Chorus

Sop. L1/L2

Alto L1/L2

Ten./Bass L

no light

- no light

- no light

- no light

- no light

light

Here now, a - wake with -

Here now, a - wake with -

Here now, a - wake with -

no light

- no light

- no light

- no light

- no light

light who sees be - yond?

Flashlights in the Dark

Shadow Chorus

Sop. S *ff*
dark night? This world is loud; what binds us now? Soul?

Alto S *ff* *mp*
— night? This world is loud; what binds us now? Oh,

Bar. S *ff* *mp*
— night? This world is loud; what binds us now? Oh,

Light Chorus

Sop. L1/L2
listen for primer tone
Who _____ sees?

Alto L1/L2
listen for primer tone
Who _____ who sees? Who sees, — Oh Life, light; life, —

Ten./Bass L
listen for primer tone
Who _____ sees? Who sees, — Oh Life, light; we are con - nec - ted by

Shadow Chorus

Sop. S
— life, — Seek - ing the

Alto S *f*
what hol - low faith is near?

Bar. S *f*
what hol - low faith is near? Here, here

(sop soloist)
ff
A - rise! Here! Look at this! A cre - a - tion age! —

Light Chorus

Sop. L1/L2
— A - - - - Here! Look at this! A cre - a - tion age! —

Alto L1/L2
rise!
life, A Here! Look at this! A cre - a - tion age! —

Ten./Bass L
light. rise! Here, here! —

swell of robot sounds rocket sounds

Shadow Chorus

Sop. S Look at this! This

Alto S Look at this! This

Bar. S Look at this! This

remember when voi - ces rang? Look at this! This

— They will build as we de - sign! Look at this!

Light Chorus

Sop. L1/L2 They will build as we de - sign! We can fin - ly i - mag - ine now. —

Alto L1/L2 They will build as we de - sign! We can fin - ly i - mag - ine now. —

Ten./Bass L They will build as we de - sign! We can fin - ly i - mag - ine now. —

17 19 *mp*

Shadow Chorus

Sop. S ten - der world. Yet love _____ shines through though in the night

Alto S ten - der world. Yet love _____ shines _____ in the night

Bar. S ten - der world. Yet love _____ shines through _____ in the night

what a world! tides will start to turn. —

Light Chorus

Sop. L1/L2 what a world! tides will start to turn. —

Alto L1/L2 what a world! tides will start to turn. —

Ten./Bass L oh — what a will start to turn. —

world! — tides will turn. —

Flashlights in the Dark

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Shadow Chorus

Sop. S
our eyes fail a - las in time we feel less and less

Alto S
our eyes fail a - las in time we feel less and less

Bar. S
our eyes fail a - las in time we feel less and less

Light Chorus

Sop. L1/L2
in the night *mp* at last *pp* *p* *mp*
we rest

Alto L1/L2
In night, *pp* *mp* at last *pp* *p* *mp*
we rest

Ten./Bass L
In night, *pp* *mp* at last *pp* *p* *mp*
we rest

31 **Andante** (♩ = 72)

29 clock ticking sounds

Shadow Chorus

Sop. S
Who can feel? Who feels

Alto S
Who can feel? Who feels

Bar. S
Who can feel? Who feels

Light Chorus

Sop. L1/L2
Here, look here, look at this! new light

Alto L1/L2
Here, look here, look at this! new light

Ten./Bass L
Here, look here, look at this! new light

new

37 38 *pp*

Sop. S
— these with - ered trees —

Alto S
— these with - ered trees — *pp* new rains fall on drea - ry —

Bar. S
— these with - ered trees — *pp* new rains fall on drea - ry —

Shin - ing in the night we bloom

Sop. L1/L2 *mp*
in night we bloom

Alto L1/L2 *mp*
Shin - ing in night bloom

Ten./Bass L *mp*
Shin - ing, sing - ing this will bloom, bloom

41 *mf* in night we

Sop. S *mf* where is the sun *mp*

Alto S *mf* where is the sun to dry our new day

Bar. S *mf* where is the sun sun to dry our new day

as au - - - tumn Here

Sop. L1/L2
as

Alto L1/L2
as au - - - tumn Here

Ten./Bass L
as au as au - - - tumn Here

tumn

Flashlights in the Dark

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Shadow Chorus

Sop. S

Alto S

Bar. S

What are won - ders

What are won - ders

for night in night; pre - ced - ing night

With co - lor pre - ced - ing night ah ah ah

Light Chorus

Sop. L1/L2

Alto L1/L2

Ten./Bass L

With co - lor pre ced - ing night ah ah ah

57

Shadow Chorus

Sop. S

Alto S

Bar. S

for night pre - ced - ing night

in night? Where sleeps

in night? Where sleeps

Where are won - ders with - out stars? Where sleeps

ah flur - ries of co - - lor in the sky

ah flur - ries of co - lor in the sky

ries of co - lor in the sky

flur - - - ries

Where sleeps

Light Chorus

Sop. L1/L2

Alto L1/L2

Ten./Bass L

flur - - - ries of co - lor in the sky

flur - - - ries of co - lor in the sky

ries of co - lor in the sky

flur - - - ries

Where sleeps

58

Shadow Chorus

Sop. S *mf* *p*
 — the light? — Deep — shad - ows live — in — night.

Alto S *mf* *p*
 — the light? — Deep — shad - ows live — in — night.

Bar. S *mf* *p*
 — the light? — Deep — shad - ows live — in — night.

Light Chorus

Sop. L1/L2
 light — deep — shad - ows

Alto L1/L2 *mf*
 — the light? —

Ten./Bass L *mf*
 Deep — shad - ows live — in — night.

66 *mf*

Shadow Chorus

Sop. S *mf*
 We car-ry on — with flash - lights we car-ry on — in — this:

Alto S *mf*
 We car-ry on — with flash - lights — in dark - ness em - brace —

Bar. S *mf*
 car - ry on Em - brace — this:

Light Chorus

Sop. L1/L2 *mf*
 We car-ry on — with flash - lights we car-ry on — in — this:

Alto L1/L2
 ours — in — this:

Ten./Bass L *mf*
 We'll car-ry ours here in dark - ness *mf*
 So here: em - brace — this:

Flashlights in the Dark

Shadow Chorus

71 *f*

Sop. S new world... Our one world... This Brave World...

Alto S *f* new world... Our one world... This Brave World...

Bar. S *f* new world... Our one world... This Brave World...

80

new world... Bright world. Bright, shared world...

Light Chorus

Sop. L1/L2 *f* new world... Bright world. Bright, shared world...

Alto L1/L2 *f* new world... Bright world. Bright, shared world...

Ten./Bass L *f* new world... Bright world. Bright, shared world...

Shadow Chorus

81 *p* Gm Eb/G Ebm/Gb F7sus4

musique concrète

8

Sop. S warm breath warm

Alto S warm breath warm hands:

Bar. S warm breath warm hands:

Light Chorus

Sop. L1/L2 8

Alto L1/L2 8

Ten./Bass L 8

93

Shadow Chorus

Sop. S

Alto S

Bar. S

Light Chorus

Sop. L1/L2

Alto L1/L2

Ten./Bass L

Chords: Fm7, Eaug, C/E, C(add9)/E, Cm/Eb Abmaj7, Abmaj7(add11), Ebaug(maj7)/Ab, Cmaj9/E

Lyrics: hands: to - - geth - - er. Should your

(E = Fb)

should your_

98

Shadow Chorus

Sop. S

Alto S

Bar. S

Light Chorus

Sop. L1/L2

Alto L1/L2

Ten./Bass L

Lyrics: car - ry yours too

hands, yours too

hands, grow wea - ry car - ry yours too

hands grow wea - ry I'll yours

hands grow wea - ry I'll car - ry your light too

wea - ry I'll car - ry yours too

hands grow wea - ry I'll car - ry your light (Yours too.)

wea - ry I'll car - ry your light too

Flashlights in the Dark

104 Eb/Bb Dm/F D-(sus4)(sus9) Dm/A Bb(add2) Fm11

Sop. S One light, though dim, with love, —

Alto S *f* One light, though dim, with love, —

Bar. S One light, though dim, dim, with love, —

Sop. L1/L2 *f* One light, though dim, with love, —

Alto L1/L2 *f* One light, though dim, with love, —

Ten./Bass L *f* One light, though dim, with love, —

Shadow Chorus

Light Chorus

110 Dbmaj7/F Cmaj9/E *mp* subito Cm(maj7)/Eb

Sop. S can pierce — can pierce — night

Alto S can pierce — can pierce — night — night

Bar. S can pierce — night — night — night

Sop. L1/L2 can pierce — night — night

Alto L1/L2 can pierce — night — night

Ten./Bass L can pierce — night — night

Shadow Chorus

Light Chorus

115 *pp* rearticulate freely in aleatoric style

Shadow Chorus

Sop. S *pp* Who? _____ who _____ who _____ who _____

Alto S *pp* Who? _____ who _____ who _____

Bar. S *p* Who _____ are we? Warm hearts light Where are we?
Who _____ are we? Warm hearts light Where are we?

Light Chorus

Sop. L1/L2 *p* Who _____ are we? Warm hearts light Where are we?

Alto L1/L2 *p* Who _____ are we? Warm hearts light Where are we?

Ten./Bass L *p* Who _____ are we? Warm hearts light Where are we?

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Shadow Chorus

Sop. S _____ who _____ who _____ who _____ who _____ who _____

Alto S who _____ who _____ who _____ who _____ who _____ who _____ who _____

Bar. S In the night. Who are we? Warm hearts light. Our new home.

Light Chorus

Sop. L1/L2 In the night.

Alto L1/L2 In the night. Who are we? Warm hearts light. Our new home.

Ten./Bass L In the night. Who are we? Warm hearts light. Our new home.

Flashlights in the Dark

rearticulate freely in aleatoric style

130

Shadow Chorus

Sop. S

Night Light Light Night

Alto S

Night Light Light Night

Bar. S

Night Light Light Night

Light Chorus

Sop. L1/L2

In the night Bring light. (Light) In the night. We bring

Alto L1/L2

In the night Bring light. (Light) In the night. We bring

Ten./Bass L

In the night Bring light. (Light) In the night. We bring

139

140 shimmering polytonal sound chandelier

Shadow Chorus

Sop. S

Light night light night light night light *ppp*

Alto S

Light night light night light night light *ppp*

Bar. S

Light night light night light night light *ppp*

(Db = C#)

light Hmm. Hmm. Hmm. Hmm. Hmm. Hmm. *pp* *ppp*

Light Chorus

Sop. L1/L2

light Hmm. Hmm. Hmm. Hmm. Hmm. Hmm. *pp* *ppp*

Alto L1/L2

light Hmm. Hmm. Hmm. Hmm. Hmm. Hmm. *pp* *ppp*

Ten./Bass L

light Hmm. Hmm. Hmm. Hmm. Hmm. Hmm. *pp* *ppp*